TT-I-556F
October 15, 1972
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. TT-I-[illegible]556e(GSA-FSS)
November 27, 1967 and
Fed. Spec. TT-I-556d
April 25, 1960

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

INK, STAMP PAD

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers quick-drying ink for use with rubber-stamp inking pads (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type and classes. The ink shall be of one type (see 1.1) and of the following classes, as specified (see 6.2):

Class 1. - For fabric pads, and for foam latex rubber or foam plastics pads.
Class 2. - For wooden pads.

1.2.2 Colors. The ink shall be furnished in the following colors, as specified (see 6.2): Black, blue, green, red, and purple.

1.2.3 Sizes (quantities of ink). The ink shall be furnished in bottles containing one, two, four or eight fluid ounces of ink, and cans containing four or eight fluid ounces as specified (see 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-121	-	Paper, Bond and Writing, White and Colored.
TT-I-600	-	Inking Pad, Rubber Stamp.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640	-	Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple Wall.
PPP-C-96	-	Cans, Metal, 28 Gage and Lighter
PPP-T-97		Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Filament Reinforced.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123	-	Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 191	-	Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers, at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W. Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Class 1, quick-drying ink for fabric pads. The ink shall be at least equal in performance, when tested as described in 4.3.1.1, 4.3.2.1, and 4.3.3.1, to ink properly prepared by dissolving dye of the kind and in the amount specified in 3.3 for the respective colors in a mixture of 1 volume of ethylene glycol and 2 volumes of distilled water.

3.2 Class 2, quick-drying ink for wooden pads. The ink shall not be injurious to rubber type, and shall not corrode the metal container of the pad when tested as described in 4.3.5 and in 4.3.6, respectively. Impressions made with the ink shall dry promptly by absorption without spreading, shall be resistant to light, and shall be waterproof when tested in accordance with 4.3.1.2, 4.3.3.2, and 4.3.4, respectively. The ink shall meet the stability test requirement of 4.3.2.2.

3.3 Dyes. The dyes to be used in obtaining the desired colors in the comparison inks described in 3.1 and the amount of each dye to be dissolved in 1 liter of the solvent mixture shall be as shown in table I.

TABLE I

Color	Dye	Color index Number 1/	Grams per liter
Black ----	Nigrosine	50420	48
Blue ----	Soluble blue	42755	24
Green ----	Light Green SF	42095	32
Red ----	Fuchsine (magenta)	42510	16
Purple(or violet)	Crystal Violet	42555	16

1/ - see paragraph 6.4

The concentration of the dyestuff shall be commercially 100 percent for the color index numbers indicated. A tolerance of 5 percent in the color concentration of the delivery will be permitted.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling. Not less than 2 fluid ounces of the ink, in an original unopened container bearing all of the manufacturer's marks, shall be submitted for inspection and tests.

4.3 Inspection and tests (ink).

4.3.1 Drying time.

4.3.1.1 Class 1. Equal volumes of the sample and of the comparison ink of the same class and color shall be spread on new inking pads conforming to the requirements for type I, class 2 and type III, class 2, of Federal Specification TT-I-600. Pads prepared as described in 6.3 may be used for fabric pads. Impressions shall be made from each pad with clean rubber stamps on white bond paper conforming to type III, class 2 of Federal Specification UU-P-121. Immediately cover the impressions with a like sheet of paper and without blotting. After 30 seconds, inspect the cover sheet. If any transfer of the comparison ink is observed, prepare a second set of impressions. This second set shall be allowed to dry for five seconds before covering. Inspect after 30 seconds as stated above. Repeat the preparation of sets of impressions allowing an additional five seconds (i.e. a total of 0, 5, 10, 15, etcetera) between sets. When the comparison ink no longer transfers to the cover sheet, there shall likewise be no transfer of the sample ink. Impressions made from the sample shall be as sharp and intensely colored as those prepared from the comparison ink.

4.3.1.2 Class 2. Equal volumes of the sample ink and of the comparison ink of the same class and color shall be spread on new wooden inking pads conforming to the requirements for Type II of Federal Specification TT-I-600. Impressions shall be made from each wooden pad with clean rubber stamps on white bond paper conforming to Type III of Federal Specification UU-P-121. Immediately cover the impressions with a like sheet of paper and without blotting. After 30 seconds, inspect the cover sheet. If any transfer of the comparison ink is observed, prepare a second set of impressions. This second set shall be allowed to dry for five seconds before covering. Inspect after 30 seconds as stated above. Repeat the preparation of sets of impressions allowing an additional five seconds (i.e. a total of 0, 5, 10, 15, etcetera) between sets. When the comparison ink no longer transfers to the cover sheet, there shall likewise be no transfer of the sample ink. Impressions made from the sample ink shall be as sharp and intensely colored as those prepared from the comparison ink.

4.3.2 Stability.

4.3.2.1 Class 1. The fabric, foam latex rubber and foam plastics pads used in testing drying time (4.3.1.1) shall be exposed, uncovered, in an atmosphere of 50 ± 5 percent relative humidity and 73.4°F. ± 3.6°F. for 8 days. The impressions made from the exposed pad shall dry as quickly and be at least as sharp and intensely colored as the impressions made before exposure. There shall be no swelling of the foam latex rubber pad.

4.3.2.2 Class 2. The wooden pad used in testing drying time (4.3.1.2) shall be exposed, uncovered, in an atmosphere of 50 ± 5 percent relative humidity and 73.4°F. ± 3.6°F. for 8 days. Impressions made from the exposed pad shall dry as quickly and shall be at least as sharp and as intensely colored as the impressions made before exposure.

4.3.3 Resistance to light.

4.3.3.1 Class 1. Impressions of the sample and of the corresponding comparison ink shall be made on white bond paper conforming to type III of Federal Specification UU-P-121. One half of the impressions shall be exposed to the radiation of a glass-enclosed, carbon-arc lamp in accordance with method 5660 of Federal Standard No. 191, after 24 hours. The remaining half of the impressions shall be covered to obscure the light. After their exposure the impressions of the sample shall show no more evidence of fading than those of the comparison ink.

4.3.3.2 Class 2. Impressions shall be made on white bond paper conforming to type III of Federal Specification UU-P-121. The impressions shall be exposed to the radiation of a glass-enclosed, carbon-arc lamp in accordance with method 5660 of Federal Standard No. 191, for 24 hours. After exposure the impressions shall be clearly legible.

4.3.4 Resistance to water (class 2). Impressions made on white bond paper conforming to type III of Federal Specification UU-P-121 shall be immersed in distilled water for 24 hours at room temperature. The impressions shall remain unchanged.

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4.3.5 Effect on rubber stamp (class 2). The type face of a clean rubber stamp shall be immersed for 10 days in the sample of class 2 ink. Surplus ink shall then be removed from the stamp and impressions shall be made with the stamp on white bond paper conforming to type III of Federal Specification UU-P-121. There shall be no evidence of swelling or softening of the rubber. The impressions shall be sharp and regular in outline.

4.3.6 Corrosion of stamp-pad container (class 2). A specimen of the metal container of a wooden inking pad conforming to type II of Federal Specification TT-I-600 shall be partially immersed for 10 days in the sample of class 2 ink, at room temperature. The metal shall show no evidence of pitting or corrosion.

4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.5 Classification of preparation for delivery defects.

TABLE II

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strappings, inadequate stapling. Distortion of container.
Contents (exterior and interior container)	Number per container is more or less than required. Net weight exceeds the box specification requirements.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. The ink shall be furnished in 1, 2, 4 or 8 ounce quantities as specified (see 6.2). The unit packaging shall be as follows:

5.1.1.1.1 One and two oz. quantities. The one and two oz. quantities shall be furnished in glass or plastic bottles of the type normally used for the product. The cap of each bottle shall be furnished with a brush of the type normally used for the application of the ink to stamp pads.

5.1.1.1.2 Four and eight oz. quantities. The four and eight oz. quantities shall be furnished in glass or plastic bottles as specified in 5.1.1.1.1 without brushes or in containers conforming to PPP-C-96 type V, class 4 as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. Twelve filled bottles or cans as described in 5.1.1.1.1 and 5.1.1.1.2 shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. When the ink is supplied in glass or plastic bottles, the box shall be fitted with half slotted partitions forming an individual cell for each bottle. The partitions shall be made of the same material as the box.

5.1.2 Level C. The ink shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers standard practice, providing that this will insure protection for the product during shipment and provide for safe delivery to its destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Ink packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed in quantities as specified (see 6.2) in close fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, V3c or V3s or to PPP-B-640, class 2. Closure and strapping of the boxes shall conform to the applicable box specification and appendix thereto.

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5.2.2 Level B. Seventy-two filled containers (6 intermediate packages) packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, grade 200 minimum. Closure of boxes shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The ink packaged as specified in 5.1.2 shall be packed in a manner that will assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification rules and the National Motor Freight Classification rules.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, all containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military requirements. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, all containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The stamp-pad ink covered by this specification is intended for making impressions on paper with a rubber stamp.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1, 5.2, and 5.3).

6.3 Test pads. A convenient substitute for commercial fabric pads can be made as follows: Rings about 1/4 inch wide are cut from brass tubing which is about 1-1/2 inches in diameter. Other rings of the same width are cut from a smaller piece of brass tubing. The tubing selected must be of such size that a large ring will fit over a small one, just tightly enough to hold taut a piece of thin muslin stretched over the small ring. Disks of felt, 1/4 inch thick, are cut to fit snugly inside the inner ring to serve as the base of the test pad. These disks can be cut by means of a die made of sharpening one end of a short piece of brass tubing. A disk of the felt is placed in a small ring which should be filled level on both sides; a circle of thin muslin is laid across the felt and is stretched smoothly by pressing the large ring into place. The pads for sample and comparison inks are placed on a pane of glass or other nonabsorbent surface. To each is applied the same measured volume of ink. This can be done by means of pipettes which can be made from glass tubing and calibrated with sufficient accuracy without much trouble.

6.4 Color Index Number. The dye numbers listed in table I are from the third edition of the Color Index issued by the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists and the Society of Dyers and Colourists.

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Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

User Interest:

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